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human beings," shrugs Haggerty. "They're fierce competitors but it's a very competitive sport and they have to be competitive. Off the court, coaches are usually the outstanding leaders of the community.

"You get hot a lot of times but you've got to be sane. You're the only sane one out there."

It turns out to be a noneventful evening for Haggerty. Only 27 fouls are called in the game and he and Overby keep the action under control throughout the contest.

The only crisis arises late in the first half when Overby whistles a foul on UTEP's Ron Jones underneath the Arizona State basket but the crowd noises drown out the whistle. The Miners retrieve the ball and drive downcourt for a basket while five seconds tick off the clock as Overby is still signalling for a time out.

When the basket is disallowed, the fans are howling and Haskins is off the bench demanding to know what happened. While Overby is catching the flak, Haggerty remains in the background and keeps a way eye on the proceedings.

"You have to analyze the situation," says Haggerty. "If your partner needs a little help you go over and break things up. You take care of

each other. He's the only friend you've got out there."

It was the closest thing to an argument all evening. Wulk jumped off the bench and kicked his chair over late in the game but it was over his disgust at an ASU turnover, not an official's call. Even the boisterous Miner fans failed to rattle the officials.

"You can sense the nearness of the crowd to the floor," notes Haggerty. "You've got to condition yourself to the responsibility of running the game and not let the hecklers get to you. New Mexico is tough and it's tough here, too. If the fans are close to the playing floor it's that much harder.

"But you've got to be able to go out there and call the game the way it should be called. You've got to see that both sides get a fair shake."

The Miners rally down the stretch to defeat the Sun Devils 69-60 and Haggerty and Overby are able to slip off the court and into the dressing room without any harassment. With the game over, the officials have once more become the forgotten men.

After a quick shower, the pair is headed to the airport to catch the first flight out of town, ready to bring law and order to another stop on the WAC trail.